

TWIGTHETICS

The Lean Athletic Physique Guide

A practical, science-based manual for getting lean, building muscle, or recomposing without living in the gym.

ABE SETH

IFBB PRO | TWIGTHETICS COACHING

How to use this guide

This is an operating system, not a motivation pamphlet. If you are brand new, start with Section 00, follow the first 14 days exactly, then use the deeper sections when you need detail. The formulas get you close. The feedback loop gets you accurate.

This guide is educational, not medical care. If you have medical conditions, a history of disordered eating, are pregnant, or are using medications or performance-enhancing drugs, work with a qualified professional before applying aggressive nutrition changes.

SECTION 04

Macro Setup

Calories set direction. Protein protects muscle. Fats support health. Carbs fuel training.

Macros should serve the goal, not become a math obsession. For physique results, the big rocks are total calories and protein. Carbs and fats can trade off somewhat based on preference, digestion, and training performance, as long as calories and protein stay controlled.

Protein

- General target: 0.7-1.0 g protein per lb bodyweight per day.
- During a cut: 0.8-1.1 g per lb is a strong default, with leaner people and more aggressive deficits using the higher end.
- During a lean gain: 0.7-0.9 g per lb is usually enough, but higher is fine if appetite and digestion are good.
- Meal distribution: 3-5 protein feedings per day is practical. Each meal should have a real protein anchor.

Fat

- Default floor: 0.25-0.35 g fat per lb bodyweight.
- Alternative: 20-30% of total calories.
- Do not drive fats extremely low for long periods just to keep carbs high.
- Prefer measured fats: eggs, avocado, olive oil, nuts, salmon, lean beef, and dairy. Do not free-pour oils or snack on nuts casually.

Carbs

After calories, protein, and fats are set, carbs fill the remaining calories. Carbs are not mandatory for fat loss, but they usually help training quality, fullness, mood, and adherence. Place more carbs around training when performance matters.

Macro	Calories per gram	Starting rule
Protein	4	0.7-1.1 g/lb depending on phase and leanness.
Carbs	4	Remainder after protein and fat. Adjust based on training and appetite.
Fat	9	0.25-0.45 g/lb or 20-30% of calories.
Alcohol	7	Not a macro target. Limit it because it displaces useful food.

Macro worksheet

Field	Your number
Starting calories	

SECTION 12

Sample Meal Templates

Use these to build days that hit calories and protein without needing chef-level effort.

Cut day template

Meal	Template
Breakfast	Egg whites plus 1-2 whole eggs, fruit or oats, coffee with low-calorie milk.
Lunch	Chicken or fish, potatoes or rice, large vegetable serving, measured avocado or olive oil.
Pre/post training	Whey isolate plus fruit or rice cakes if needed.
Dinner	Lean protein, huge salad or vegetables, controlled carb, measured fat.
Hunger snack	Fat-free Greek yogurt with berries and Splenda, or egg whites with vegetables.

Lean gain template

Meal	Template
Breakfast	Greek yogurt or eggs, oats, fruit, and a measured fat source.
Lunch	Chicken, rice, vegetables, avocado or olive oil.
Pre training	Carb-focused meal: rice, potatoes, oats, fruit, or cereal if it fits.
Dinner	Lean beef/salmon/chicken, potatoes or rice, vegetables.
Extra calories	Add carbs first if training performance needs help; add fats if appetite is low.

Meal-plan rules

- If you use a meal plan, execute the meal plan. Do not turn every food into an open-ended option list.
- If you need a swap, swap like-for-like: lean protein for lean protein, carb for carb, fat for fat.
- Do not add oils, sauces, nuts, bites, and drinks without accounting for them.
- If hunger is high, increase low-calorie vegetables and lean protein volume before changing the calorie target.

SECTION 17

Sample Routine: 5-Day Physique Split

For people who enjoy the gym and recover well, but still want sessions that are focused.

Day	Body parts	Main work
1	Chest + shoulders	Incline press, flat press, fly, shoulder press, lateral raise.
2	Back + arms	Pulldown, cable row, chest-supported row, pressdown, curl, hammer curl.
3	Legs	Hack squat/leg press, RDL, leg curl, leg extension, calves.
4	Chest + back	Machine chest press, neutral pulldown, incline press, single-arm row, fly, abs.
5	Shoulders + arms	Shoulder press, lateral raise, rear delts, triceps, biceps, abs.

This split works when recovery, sleep, and nutrition are stable. It is not automatically better than 3-4 days. It just distributes volume into shorter, more specialized sessions.

Abs twice weekly

- Use cable crunches and either ab machine crunches or hanging/lying leg raises.
- Do 2-4 rounds of 10-15 reps per exercise.
- Progress the load or reps the same way you progress other muscles.
- Do abs on days you are already in the gym, not as random homework you will skip.

SECTION 23

Personal Calculator Worksheet

Fill this in before starting.

Field	Your number
Goal phase: cut / gain / recomp / maintenance	
Current bodyweight	
Target bodyweight range	
Training days per week	
Average daily steps now	
Step target	
Estimated maintenance calories	
Starting target calories	
Protein target	
Fat target	
Carb target	
Weekly weight-change target	
Review date after 14 days	